

My Own Streaming Radio



Looking for a way to stream your music over the home network? MPD (Music Player Daemon) with the Icecast server could be a viable option.

*I*cecast? Don't worry, I am not going to talk about chiselling sculptures out of ice here. Icecast is a server—an audio streaming server to be precise. It can broadcast both MP3 and Ogg Vorbis format audio in the form of streams. What I wanted was to be able to access my music library on my iPod Touch while at home. So, I was looking for a way to stream my music over the home network. After a little search and review, MPD (Music Player Daemon) with the Icecast server seemed to be the best option.

With this set-up, you can run even your own Internet radio. You can select the bit rate of the stream, the number of channels to stream, and the quality of the Ogg streams...there are numerous options to choose from.

"My own radio? Wow! Where do I begin?"

It's fairly simple actually. We will cover the basics about creating and using a basic MPD set-up, which can be used as a local streaming service on your machine. Personally, I find it better than most players out there. This will, in turn, help us with the streaming application in the backend. Then, we will explore setting up Icecast. Take a look at Figures 1 and 2 to get a more holistic view.

Music Player Daemon

MPD (Music Player Daemon) is a daemon (a piece of software that runs in the background) that manages your music for you. It's a client-server architecture. MPD acts as a server; and when you install a client, you can use it to interact with MPD and play